Signet 01

Jim Hannon-Tan, 2026

925 sterling silver, planar spiral antenna, secure cryptographic element
Foundation Edition · 10 numbered pieces · US$10,000

The premise

For three thousand years a signet ring did one thing. It put a person's mark on a document, in their presence, by their hand. The mark could not be lent, copied or delegated. It was the person.

Signing has since become weightless. A name is typed, a box is ticked, software acts in our place. As machines grow able to produce and execute almost anything on our behalf, two things remain scarce: a human decision, deliberately made, and a human name, deliberately given.

Signet 01 returns the mark to the hand. It is a ring that signs.

The instrument

Signet 01 is investment-cast in 925 sterling silver and finished by hand at the bench. Silver was chosen for two reasons. It is the most conductive metal, and it is the metal signets have been made from for as long as there have been signets.

The face carries a twelve-turn square spiral. It is the ring's mark, and it is also its antenna. Held to a phone, the spiral draws a moment of energy from the phone's field and wakes a secure element seated beneath it. There is no battery, no charging, nothing to replace in ordinary use.

The secure element holds a single private key, generated inside the silicon. The key cannot leave it. The ring can sign; it cannot be read, copied or cloned. The circuit is the ornament and the ornament is the circuit.

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The seal

Signet 01 does one thing. It seals words.

Write. Read what you have written. Touch the ring to your phone. The words are sealed.

A seal is a permanent record, held on a public ledger, that these exact words were signed by this ring at this moment. It carries the holder's name as entered in the Register. It cannot be altered afterwards; change one character and the seal no longer matches.

Each seal is an object in its own right. It has an address. It can be shown, sent, quoted or kept, and anyone with the address can read the words and confirm their author and their time.

What a person seals is theirs to decide: a declaration, a dedication, a letter to be opened later, an approval, a statement that these words are mine.

What a seal proves

A seal proves three things, and we are precise about them.

1. That this ring signed these exact words. The signature can be checked by anyone against the ring's public key, using open standards, without HANNON TAN.
2. When. The ledger records the moment the seal was made.
3. Who holds the ring. The Register binds each numbered piece to its holder of record, and records every change of hands.

A seal does not prove that the holder read the words with care, nor that the ring was on the right hand. That is what the gesture is for. A signet has always rested on the same trust: that a person guards what is precious to them. Signet 01 is made to be worn, kept and guarded, and the Register is there for the day it is not.

The Register

The Register is the house's book of record. For every numbered piece it holds the origin of the metal, the date of casting, the hands that made it, the holder of record and each change of holder, the ring's key and every authorised change to that key.

The Register is what makes a seal mean someone. The ledger proves a ring signed; the Register says whose ring it is. The two are kept apart on purpose. A seal can be verified by anyone without the Register, and the Register can be consulted without revealing what has been sealed.

A holder may pass a ring on. The Register records the transfer, the old holder's seals remain theirs, and the ring begins a new line.

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The Foundation Edition

Ten numbered pieces. US$10,000. Delivery from the first quarter of 2027.

The Foundation Edition is the first ten signets of their kind. Their holders are the first ten names in the Register, and will remain so. Each holder receives:

- Signet 01, numbered 01 to 10, hallmarked, cast and finished in Adelaide, sized to the hand.
- A unique signing key, generated inside the ring at assembly and witnessed in the Register.
- Entry in the Register under the holder's name, with the ring's metallurgical origin, casting date and lineage.
- The First Seal: the holder's first words, sealed at handover and entered as the first line of that ring's record.
- A numbered monograph and a certificate of the ring's key, signed by Jim Hannon-Tan.
- A case made for the ring.
- Studio service, as set out below.

The price buys a founding instrument from a new house, made in small numbers by named hands, with a record that will outlast the technology inside it. Later editions will be larger. There will be no second Foundation.

Service

The silver will outlast the silicon, and the ring is built on that assumption.

- The secure element is a calibre, seated so it can be replaced. When cryptographic standards move on, the studio fits a new calibre; the chassis, hallmark and number are untouched. The change is recorded in the Register. Service is charged when performed.
- Seals made under an earlier key stay valid. They were true when made, and the ledger does not forget.
- A lost or stolen ring is revoked in the Register on the holder's word. Nothing signed by it afterwards carries the holder's name. A replacement is made under the same number, with a new key, and the record shows it.
- Verification does not depend on the house. The standards are open and the seals live on a public ledger.

There is no subscription. Sealing is what the ring is for.

Provenance

Signet 01 grew from Near Field Circuit, Genesis Edition (2025): ten seals CNC-machined from solid brass, copper-plated and hand-assembled, each carrying an Arx HaLo chip bonded to an LSP8 token on LUKSO. A tap recorded presence and ownership to the holder's Universal Profile. All ten were sold and are held by collectors around the world.

nearfieldcircuit.com

Near Field Circuit was supported by the LUKSO Grants Program, and it is where the ring's software lineage begins. Signet 01 has been developed with ANFF-C Gate 1 funding and with the support of the Australian National Fabrication Facility.

Jim Hannon-Tan is an industrial designer. His work runs from everyday and cultural objects to medical technology and digital instruments, for clients including Alessi and Schneider Electric, after fifteen years in the studios of Milan, Amsterdam and London. He works from Adelaide, Australia.

Makers

Industrial design	Jim Hannon-Tan
Casting	Morris & Watson
Bench work	Shannon Cornish Artisan Jewellers
Vitreous enamel R&D	JamFactory, Adelaide
Mechanical engineering	Varghese Liju
Electronic engineering	Aaron Mohtar
RF and antenna consultancy	Dr Shengjian Chen, Flinders University
Ledger and application	Aureliano Alarcón Smith

With thanks to Cameron Robertson, founder of Arx, and Fabian Vogelsteller, co-founder of LUKSO.

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Technical specifications

For those who want to check the claims above.

Chassis	925 sterling silver, investment cast, hand finished, hallmarked and numbered
Antenna	Integrated 12-turn planar square spiral · 13.56 MHz · tuned to the chassis
Secure element	Arx HaLo passive NFC · no battery
Key	ECDSA secp256k1 · generated on-silicon · non-exportable
Message format	EIP-712 typed structured data · the ring signs the digest of the exact text
Seal	An LSP8 token minted on LUKSO, carrying the signature, the digest, the timestamp and the text
Identity	LUKSO Universal Profile (ERC-725) · the ring's key is a controller with definable, revocable permissions
Verification	Open · recover the signer from the signature and compare to the ring's public key, with no dependence on HANNON TAN
Serviceability	Secure element seated as a replaceable calibre · chassis and number persist across calibre changes

Allocation

Ten pieces. Requests are read and answered personally. An allocation is confirmed by a deposit, with the balance due at delivery. The first casting closes 15 December 2026.

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